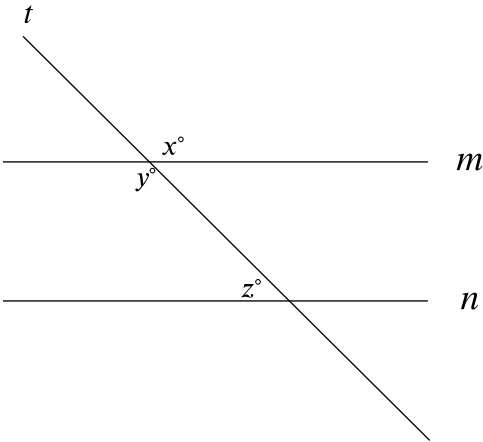


Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Lines, angles, and triangles	Medium

Question



Note: Figure not drawn to scale.

In the figure, lines m and n are parallel. If $x = 6k + 13$ and $y = 8k - 29$, what is the value of z ?

Answer

- A. 3
- B. 21
- C. 41
- D. 139

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. Vertical angles, which are angles that are opposite each other when two lines intersect, are congruent. The figure shows that lines t and m intersect. It follows that the angle with measure x° and the angle with measure y° are vertical angles, so $x = y$. It's given that $x = 6k + 13$ and $y = 8k - 29$. Substituting $6k + 13$ for x and $8k - 29$ for y in the equation $x = y$ yields $6k + 13 = 8k - 29$. Subtracting $6k$ from both sides of this equation yields $13 = 2k - 29$. Adding 29 to both sides of this equation yields $42 = 2k$, or $2k = 42$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 2 yields $k = 21$. It's given that lines m and n are parallel, and the figure shows that lines m and n are intersected by a transversal, line t . If two parallel lines are intersected by a transversal, then the same-side interior angles are supplementary. It follows that the same-side interior angles with measures y° and z° are supplementary, so $y + z = 180$. Substituting $8k - 29$ for y in this equation yields $8k - 29 + z = 180$. Substituting 21 for k in this equation yields $8(21) - 29 + z = 180$, or $139 + z = 180$. Subtracting 139 from both sides of this equation yields $z = 41$. Therefore, the value of z is 41 .

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the value of k , not z .

Choice D is incorrect. This is the value of x or y , not z .